Such thinking over long time horizons diverges from the cult of speed that is often found in Indian public policy, where three-page notes are written over a weekend and implemented over the week. Such actions tend to be superficial and achieve little.

There is a pipeline of the policy process, from measurement all the way to policy execution. The institutional memory of each field is contained in a community of intellectuals and policy practitioners. The pipeline and the community need to be nurtured, in order to play the long battles of policy reform.

We in India now know that a bridge across a river is a project that has to go through certain steps. It takes time, money and professional capacity in order to build a bridge. We have to see policy reforms in a similar way. There is no short cut from the date on which it is decided that a bridge shall be built, to the date on which the bridge is inaugurated.

Building the republic takes time. It will take many decades of hard work by the policy community for India to rise to the ranks of the advanced nations of the world. Policy reform is slow, hard work, and not amenable to quick wins on social media.